

Course Title: Project Management

Course Overview: Project Management in Action – Excel to Jira

Duration: 12 Weeks

Sessions: 2 per week (2 hours each)

Format: Hands-on training, software demos, collaborative exercises, and capstone project

Instructor: SHUAIBU Kasim Dodo, Harley Innovation Hub, Lafia

Audience: Beginners–Intermediate learners

Course Focus

From planning to execution — learners will **do** project management using Microsoft Excel (Weeks 1–3) and Jira (Weeks 4–12), with practical, team-based exercises and performance dashboards.

Expected Outcomes

By the end of this course, learners will be able to:

1. Create and manage projects end-to-end using Excel and Jira.
2. Build dashboards and visual performance trackers.
3. Collaborate and lead project teams using agile workflows.
4. Present data-driven project insights for real-world decision-making.
5. Develop readiness for advanced tools like Power BI.

Software Transition Plan

- **Weeks 1–3:** Excel-based Project Management — building foundational understanding using spreadsheets, Gantt charts, cost models, and dashboards.

- **Weeks 4–12:** Jira-based Project Management — using Jira to manage live projects, track progress, manage sprints, and visualize team performance.

Weekly Breakdown (Practical Focus)

Week 1:

Focus & Tools: Introduction to Project Management with Excel

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Set up a personal project workbook.
- Identify a real-world project.
- Map its lifecycle in Excel (Initiation → Closure).

Week 2:

Focus & Tools: Initiation & Feasibility Analysis

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Create a business case and stakeholder register in Excel.
- Build a project charter using templates.

Week 3:

Focus & Tools: Scope & Planning (Excel)

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Develop a Work Breakdown Structure (WBS).
- Design a Gantt chart using Excel formulas & conditional formatting.
- Present timeline & dependencies.

Week 4:

Focus & Tools: Transition to Jira: Setting Up Projects

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Create a Jira account & project.
- Configure workflows, roles, and boards.
- Replicate Excel project into Jira.

Week 5:

Focus & Tools: Task Management & Scheduling in Jira

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Add issues, subtasks, and sprints.
- Link dependencies & milestones.
- Compare Excel Gantt vs. Jira board.

Week 6:

Focus & Tools: Cost & Resource Management

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Create a budget tracker in Excel.
- Assign resources in Jira.
- Monitor costs vs actuals.

Week 7:

Focus & Tools: Risk & Quality Management

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Build a risk register in Excel.
- Create issue tags & labels for quality control in Jira.
- Generate quality status dashboards.

Week 8:

Focus & Tools: Communication & Leadership

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Conduct a simulated team stand-up meeting.
- Manage comments, mentions, and updates in Jira.
- Track collaboration analytics.

Week 9:

Focus & Tools: Monitoring & Reporting

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Design performance dashboards in Excel using PivotTables & slicers.
- Generate Jira reports & burndown charts.

Week 10:

Focus & Tools: Change Control & Stakeholder Updates

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Implement change requests in Jira.
- Track change impact in Excel dashboard.
- Present weekly progress report.

Week 11:

Focus & Tools: Final Capstone Project

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Plan and execute a live project (team-based).
- Manage it fully in Jira.
- Submit reports with Excel analysis visuals.

Week 12:

Focus & Tools: Reflection, Review & Next Steps

Hands-on Practical Activities:

- Peer review session.
- Create a personal portfolio of project deliverables.
- Guidance on Power BI integration (for future skill growth).

Key Deliverables

Excel Deliverables (Weeks 1–3):

- Gantt Chart
- Budget Tracker
- Risk Register
- Performance Dashboard

Jira Deliverables (Weeks 4–12):

- Configured Project Board
- Task & Sprint Management System
- Quality Control Board
- Capstone Project Execution